

AoE2 Tournament Agent

Version 6 — Platform Organiser Guide
Age of Empires II: Definitive Edition

Everything you need to run tournaments for multiple Discord communities from one platform.

Installation · Hosting · Tournament Requests · Per-Division Fees · Host Kickback · Revenue Tracking

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1. What Is This App & How You Make Money

The **AoE2 Tournament Agent** is a single web application that hosts unlimited AoE2 community tournaments simultaneously. Each community gets their own isolated URL, admin panel, player roster, and bracket system — all powered by one app that you control.

Revenue model — PayPal-based, fully tracked:

Fee Type	Who Gets It	Amount	How It's Paid
Platform Admin Fee	You	You set it per tournament (e.g. \$5 per player)	Player pays via PayPal directly to your email
Prize Pool Fee	Discord host	Host sets it per division — can vary by ELO tier	Player pays via PayPal directly to host's email
Host Kickback	Discord host	You set a % of your admin fee to share back	You send manually, tracked in the app

Each player pays **two separate PayPal payments** — one to you, one to the tournament host. The app generates pre-filled PayPal links with the amount and a tracking note containing the player's email, the tournament name, and their Discord tag, so every payment is easy to match to a player.

New since the last version: prize fees are now set **per division**, not one flat amount per tournament. A host can make their Bronze division free to encourage new players, while charging \$10 for their Diamond division. You can also share a kickback percentage of your admin fee back to hosts as an incentive for running active communities.

Example with 5 communities, 80 players each, \$5 admin fee:

$5 \times 80 \times \$5 = \text{\$2,000}$ in **gross admin fees** per tournament season — minus whatever kickback % you've chosen to share with hosts.

Placement games are always free in every division, regardless of that division's prize fee. The fee only gates entry into the Swiss bracket itself.

Privacy by design: Your admin fee profit and kickback math are visible only to you, behind your platform master password. Tournament admins and players never see your earnings — they only see the prize pool total, which is everyone's business since it funds the prizes.

2. Requirements

- 1 **Node.js** (free) from nodejs.org — install once
- 2 **Any modern browser** (Chrome or Edge recommended)
- 3 **The app file** — `aoe2-tournament.jsx` (in your zip)

Recommended: Host online (Section 5) so every Discord server can access their tournament URL without you needing your PC running.

3. Installation on Windows 11

Step A — Install Node.js

- 1 Go to <https://nodejs.org>
- 2 Click the big green LTS button
- 3 Double-click the downloaded file, click Next through every screen

Step B — Set up your project folder

Create a folder, e.g.: **C:\Users\YourName\Documents\aoe2-agent**

Put **aoe2-tournament.jsx** inside the **src** subfolder.

Step C — Open Terminal in the folder

Press Windows key, type Terminal, press Enter. Then:

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\Documents\aoe2-agent
```

Step D — Create the React project

```
npm create vite@latest . -- --template react
```

When asked: y → React → JavaScript. Then run:

```
npm install
```

Step E — Connect the app

- 1 Copy aoe2-tournament.jsx into the src folder
- 2 Open src/App.jsx in Notepad, delete everything, paste:

```
import TournamentApp from './aoe2-tournament' export default function  
App(){ return }
```

Save and close.

4. Running the App Locally

- 1 Open Terminal and navigate to your folder
- 2 Type: **npm run dev** and press Enter
- 3 Open browser and go to: **http://localhost:5173**
- 4 Leave Terminal open while using the app
- 5 To stop: press Ctrl + C in Terminal

URL structure: `http://localhost:5173/` — Landing page with all tournaments
`http://localhost:5173/#/admin` — Platform admin dashboard
`http://localhost:5173/#/t/CODE` — Specific tournament (replace CODE)

5. Hosting Online (Recommended)

Host online so every Discord server can access their tournament URL from anywhere, on any device, without you keeping your PC on.

Recommended: Railway.app (free tier available)

- 1 Create account at **<https://railway.app>**
- 2 Create a GitHub account at **<https://github.com>** and upload your project files
- 3 In Railway: New Project → Deploy from GitHub repo → select your repo
- 4 Add build command: **npm run build** and start command: **npm run start**
- 5 Railway gives you a public URL like: **<https://aoe2-agent-abc.railway.app>**
- 6 Now each tournament is accessible at:
<https://aoe2-agent-abc.railway.app/#/t/CODE>

Important: Change your master password immediately from the default 'Wireless' once deployed.

6. Your Platform Admin Dashboard (/#/admin)

Navigate to **/#/admin** (e.g. yourapp.com/#!/admin) and enter your master password.

Admin Tab	What It Shows
■ Dashboard	Total tournaments, pending requests, total players, total prize pools, your private profit, open disputes
■ Requests	Incoming tournament request tickets — approve or reject
■ Tournaments	All tournaments with URLs, admin passwords, admin fee, kickback %, fee summaries
■ Fees	Complete revenue breakdown — gross fees, kickback owed/paid, your net profit
■■ Settings	Change master password, export/restore full platform backup
■ Log	Platform-level activity log

7. Reviewing Tournament Requests (Tickets)

Instead of letting anyone create a tournament instantly, the landing page has a '■ **Request a Tournament**' button that submits a ticket for your review.

What a requester submits:

- 1 Their email address
- 2 Desired tournament name
- 3 Desired URL code (optional — you can adjust it)
- 4 Their Discord server / community name
- 5 A free-text message describing their community

The moment someone submits a request, two things happen:

- 1 The ticket is saved instantly to your Requests tab — it's never lost even if the next step fails.
- 2 An email alert is sent to you via Formspree with subject line 'AOE2', so you're notified right away.

Reviewing a request:

- 1 Go to **Platform Admin** → ■ **Requests**.
- 2 Pending tickets are listed with the requester's details and message.
- 3 Click ✓ **Approve** — this opens the New Tournament modal prefilled with their desired name/code/host name, so you can review and adjust the admin fee and kickback % before actually creating it.
- 4 Click ✕ **Reject** if it's not a good fit — the requester is not auto-notified, so follow up by email yourself if needed.
- 5 Resolved tickets move to a history list where you can delete old ones.

Why a ticket system instead of instant self-service? This gives you control over admin fees, kickback %, and overall quality before a tournament goes live under your platform's name.

8. Creating a Tournament Directly

You can also skip the ticket system entirely and create a tournament yourself anytime.

- 1 Log into Platform Admin (/#/admin).
- 2 Click **+ New Tournament** (works from any tab).
- 3 Fill in the form:

Field	What to Enter	Example
Tournament Code	Short URL-friendly ID. Letters, numbers, hyphens only.	NA-KINGS
Tournament Name	Full name shown on the tournament home page.	North America Kings
Host / Server Name	The Discord server or community name.	NA AoE2 Community
Admin Password	Password the server host uses for their admin panel.	(leave blank for 'changeme')
Platform Admin Fee	Your cut per player, in \$.	\$5
Host Kickback %	% of your admin fee shared back to this host.	0–100, e.g. 10

- 1 Click **Create Tournament**.
- 2 The tournament URL is instantly shown: **yourURL/#!/t/NA-KINGS**

Tell every host: Change your admin password immediately after first login. Admin → Passwords → Change Admin Password.

9. Handing Off to a Discord Server Host

After creating the tournament (directly or via an approved ticket), send the host:

Item	What to Send	Example
Tournament URL	Their unique tournament address	https://yourapp.railway.app/#/t/NA-KING5
Admin Password	The password you set (or 'changeme')	changeme — tell them to change it!
How to access admin	Click Admin in their tournament nav	Enter their password to unlock
Admin fee / kickback	Inform them of both — admin fee is read-only to them, kickback is visible to them as a bonus they're owed	\$5 fee, 10% kickback

What the host does next:

- 1 Open their tournament URL and click Admin.
- 2 Enter their password and go to Season settings.
- 3 Add their PayPal email — required before they can launch a paid bracket.
- 4 Go to Tiers and set a prize fee PER DIVISION (can be \$0 for some, paid for others).
- 5 Set prize splits (1st/2nd/3rd %) per division, then click Save Divisions.
- 6 Set time windows for their community's timezone, then click Save Time Windows.
- 7 Configure placement match settings, then click Save Placement Settings.
- 8 Click Open Registration when ready.
- 9 Share the tournament URL with their Discord server members.

10. Per-Division Prize Fees — How They Work

Every division (tier) in a tournament now has its **own** prize fee, set independently by the host. This lets a community make entry-level divisions free while charging for competitive ones.

Division	ELO Range	Example Prize Fee
Bronze	0–499	\$0 (free)
Silver	500–799	\$5
Gold	800–1099	\$5
Diamond	1100+	\$10

The **platform admin fee** still applies uniformly across every division in a tournament — only the prize fee varies. A player's total entry cost is: **your admin fee + that specific division's prize fee**.

This affects several places in the app automatically:

- 1 Registration page shows a fee badge per division so players know the cost before they're even classified.
- 2 Tournament home page shows free/paid badges and a live prize pool per division.
- 3 A player's PayPal payment buttons charge exactly their own division's prize fee, once they're classified.
- 4 The Payments admin tab shows each player's owed amount based on their specific division.
- 5 Bracket-opening logic checks each player's specific tier fee — free divisions never block on payment status.

11. Host Kickback — Profit Sharing

You can share a percentage of your platform admin fee back to a tournament's host, as a thank-you for running an active community. This is entirely optional and set per tournament.

Setting it up:

- 1 When creating a tournament (or reviewing it later in Platform Admin → Tournaments), set the **Host Kickback %** field.
- 2 Example: 10% kickback on a \$5 admin fee means you owe the host \$0.50 for every player whose payment you confirm.

How it's tracked:

- 1 Every time a player's payment is confirmed as Received, their admin fee is logged.
- 2 $\text{Kickback owed} = (\text{total admin fees collected for that tournament}) \times (\text{kickback \%})$ — calculated live, no manual math.
- 3 Go to **Platform Admin** → **Tournaments** to see Owed / Paid / Outstanding for each tournament.
- 4 Click '**■ Record Payout to Host**' whenever you actually send them their share via PayPal — this logs the amount, date, and an optional note (like a transaction ID).
- 5 This is a manual ledger, not an automatic payment — you still send the money yourself; the app just tracks what's owed vs. paid.

What the host sees:

In their own Season settings tab, the host sees a '**■ Your Hosting Bonus**' card showing the %, amount earned, amount paid, and outstanding balance — builds trust without exposing your platform-wide profit totals.

Your revenue dashboard:

Platform Admin → Fees now shows: Gross Admin Fee Revenue, Total Kickback Owed, Total Kickback Paid, and your **Net Profit (after kickback)** — your real take-home figure.

12. Configuring a Tournament (Full Walkthrough)

A full configuration walkthrough for each Admin tab — remember each settings tab now has a **Save button** at the bottom. Edits are held locally until you click Save, so you can review changes before committing them.

Admin → Season

- 1 Set Season Name, Placement Games, Swiss Rounds, Top N Playoff Cutoff, Default Prize Fee for new divisions
- 2 Platform Admin Fee is shown read-only — only you can set this in `/#/admin`
- 3 Add the host's PayPal Email — required before any paid bracket can open
- 4 Click **Save Season Settings** — a bar at the bottom shows '● Unsaved changes' until you do

Admin → Tiers

Each tier = one ELO division with its own Swiss bracket, champion, and now its own prize fee and prize split. Edit freely, then click **Save Divisions** once you're happy with all of them.

13. Setting Time Windows for Placement Matches

Go to **Admin** → **Time Windows**. Time windows define when the agent is allowed to schedule placement matches. Matches are spread evenly across these windows only.

Community Type	Recommended Time Windows (UTC)
USA only	Sat 18:00–23:00 + Sun 18:00–23:00 (ET noon–5pm, PT 10am–3pm)
UK only	Sat 12:00–21:00 + Sun 12:00–21:00 (GMT noon–9pm)
China only	Sat 08:00–15:00 + Sun 08:00–15:00 (CST 4pm–11pm)
USA + UK mix	Sat 16:00–21:00 (ET noon–5pm AND GMT 4pm–9pm at the same time)
No preference	Leave empty — 2-hour gaps, no day restriction

After adding/editing windows, click **Save Time Windows** to commit them.

Key rule: All times are UTC. Players always see their match times converted to their own registered timezone automatically.

14. Opening and Closing Registration

Opening registration (Admin → Season → Open Registration):

- 1 The tournament home page now shows a Register button.
- 2 Players can self-register from this moment.
- 3 No admin involvement needed — players fill in all their own details.

Closing registration (Admin → Season → Close & Generate Schedule):

- 1 The agent immediately generates all placement match pairings.
- 2 Pairings are ELO-balanced and rematch-free.
- 3 Time slots are drawn from your saved time windows and spread evenly.
- 4 Every match gets a unique lobby name and password.
- 5 Players log in and see their full schedule instantly — no admin action needed.

This is your most important click. Everything else in the tournament runs automatically once you close registration and generate the schedule.

15. Generating the Placement Schedule

When you close registration, the scheduling algorithm runs automatically:

- 1 Every player is paired with N opponents (N = placement games setting, default 5).
- 2 Pairings minimise ELO difference between opponents.
- 3 No rematches within the same season.
- 4 Time slots are drawn from your time windows, spread evenly.
- 5 Each match gets a unique lobby name (e.g. NA-KINGS-R01-THEVvCLAN) and password.

16. Opening Division Brackets

- 1 Once enough players are classified (minimum 2 per division), go to **Admin** → **Season**.
- 2 Click **Open Division Brackets**.
- 3 The agent checks each player against their SPECIFIC division's fee — free divisions never block, paid divisions require the player's payment status to be Received.
- 4 Each qualifying division opens simultaneously in Settings Vote phase.
- 5 Players log in and vote on their preferred map, resources, and speed.
- 6 Lock Settings, then Start Swiss R1 (or Start All Swiss for everything at once).

17. Running Swiss Rounds

Phase	Who Acts	What Happens
Matches play	Players	Both players find lobby info in their portal and play
Results reported	Players	Both report; auto-confirmed if they agree
Round complete	Auto-detected	Next Round button lights up gold
Advance round	Admin — 1 click	Click Next Round in the Bracket tab
After final round	Admin — 1 click	Click Cut to Top 8

18. Top 8 Playoff

After Swiss completes, the top 8 players by record (Buchholz tiebreaker) advance to seeded single-elimination playoffs.

Seed	Opponent
1st	8th
2nd	7th
3rd	6th
4th	5th

19. PayPal Payments & Revenue Tracking

Every player entry fee is split into two separate PayPal payments — one to you (admin fee), one to the tournament host (their division's prize fee).

Status	Meaning
■ No Payment Submitted	Player has not yet told the app they've paid
■ Submitted	Player clicked 'I've Paid Both Fees' — host needs to verify in PayPal
■ Received	Host confirmed the money arrived. Player can now enter the bracket.

You verify your own admin fee payments separately in your PayPal account using the tracking note. The host only confirms the prize fee they personally receive.

20. Managing Players (Ban, Classify, Password Reset)

Action	How	Effect
Ban player	Click Ban → confirm	Account suspended, email blocked from re-registering
Unban player	Click Unban	Account restored
Manually classify	Click Classify	Player placed into their ELO division without completing placements
Reset password	Admin → Passwords → Reset	Player receives a new password you set

21. Dispute Resolution

- 1 The header shows a red dispute count when any match is in conflict.
- 2 Go to the Bracket tab — disputed matches are listed in a red banner at the top.
- 3 Click Resolve next to the match.
- 4 Review the game recordings (both players are required to record).
- 5 Click the correct winner's name. Result is confirmed and marked admin-resolved.

22. Backup & Restore

Platform-level (all tournaments):

- 1 /#/admin → Settings → ■ Export Master Backup
- 2 To restore: ■ Restore Backup → select file

Per-tournament:

- 1 Inside any tournament: Admin → Data → Export/Restore Backup

23. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
npm run dev fails	Run npm install first. Delete node_modules and retry.
Tournament URL shows Not Found	Check tournament code in /#/admin. Must match exactly (case-sensitive).
Changes don't survive a refresh	Make sure you clicked the Save button at the bottom of the settings panel — edits are local until saved.
Can't open brackets	Need classified, paid (if applicable) players in that specific division.
Master password forgotten	DevTools (F12) → Application → Local Storage → delete 'aoe2_v5_superpw' → default 'Wireless' restored.